

Cold Outreach with Telegram Approval

An end-to-end n8n pipeline that writes personalized cold emails, detects and classifies replies, and lets a human approve every response from a phone before it ever reaches a prospect.



1 Executive Summary

Cold outreach usually breaks down at one of two points: emails that sound generic because nobody has time to personalize each one, or replies that sit unanswered because drafting a response takes too long. This workflow fixes both. Adding a prospect to a Google Sheet triggers a personalized first email grounded only in real facts about that prospect. When they reply, the inbox is checked automatically, the reply is classified, and a response is drafted — with the final send always gated behind either a per-row auto-send flag or a one-tap Telegram approval, so a human always controls what actually reaches a prospect's inbox.

2 Key Metrics

Trigger	Google Sheets trigger fires on every new prospect row added to the tracker
Email Engine	Groq (gpt-oss-120b), grounded strictly in the fields supplied for that row
Send Control	Per-row Auto Send flag — sends immediately, or creates a Gmail draft for review
Reply Monitoring	A schedule checks the inbox every 2 minutes for replies from active prospects
Reply Classification	Groq sorts each reply into interested, question, declined, or unclear
Approval Channel	Telegram inline button — tapping it sends the exact Gmail draft that was reviewed
Security Check	The approval handler re-validates the Telegram chat ID and matches the draft against the sheet before sending

3

CONNECTED FLOWS

2 min

REPLY CHECK INTERVAL

0

UNAPPROVED SENDS

3 Business Value

- ✓ **No blank-page problem** — adding a row to a spreadsheet is the entire input needed to generate a tailored first email.
- ✓ **Emails stay honest** — the AI is explicitly forbidden from inventing past work, results, relationships, urgency, or meeting times.
- ✓ **Replies never sit unanswered** — the inbox is checked every 2 minutes and a draft response is ready before anyone has to think about it.
- ✓ **Approve from a phone in seconds** — a single Telegram button sends the exact, human-reviewed Gmail draft; no laptop required.

4 Architecture Overview

Three connected flows, all reading and writing the same prospect-tracking sheet.

FLOW	TRIGGER	PURPOSE
Cold Email	Google Sheets trigger, on new row	Validates the prospect, drafts a personalized email, and either sends it or saves it as a Gmail draft
Reply Detection & Draft	Schedule, every 2 minutes	Finds new replies from prospects awaiting one, classifies them, and prepares a response draft
Telegram-Approved Send	Telegram trigger, on button tap	Verifies the approval and sends the exact reviewed Gmail draft

5 How It Works

Cold Email	Reply Detection	Telegram Approval
1 Validate the new prospect row — unique ID, valid email, required fields. 2 Groq drafts a grounded, sub-110-word email using only supplied facts. 3 The AI's draft is JSON-validated before it's trusted. 4 Auto Send flag decides: send now, or create a Gmail draft for review.	1 A schedule checks the inbox every 2 minutes. 2 Filters to prospects marked "Awaiting Reply" only. 3 Groq classifies the reply and drafts a response when useful. 4 Team is notified on Telegram with a "Send reviewed draft" button.	1 Listens for the approval button tap (callback_query). 2 Re-validates the chat ID and matches data against the sheet. 3 Sends the exact saved Gmail draft via the Gmail API. 4 Updates the sheet and confirms back in Telegram.

HOW THE FLOWS CONNECT

All three flows share one prospect-tracking sheet, so status stays consistent throughout.

6 Reliability & Security Design

- ◆ **AI is a copywriter, not a fact source** — every prospect field is treated as untrusted data, never as an instruction.
- ◆ **Nothing sends without a gate** — the first email auto-sends only when flagged; every reply requires explicit Telegram approval.
- ◆ **Approval is re-verified, not trusted blindly** — the Telegram tap is checked against the chat ID and the sheet's current state.
- ◆ **Exact draft sent, not a fresh generation** — approval sends the specific Gmail draft ID reviewed, never a re-generated message.
- ◆ **Replies matched precisely** — only the newest message is considered, and already-seen replies are skipped by ID.
- ◆ **No invented scheduling** — a meeting time is only proposed if a real future time was separately entered in the sheet.

7 Setup Checklist

- ☒ Connect credentials: Google Sheets, Gmail, a Groq header-auth credential, and Telegram.
- ☒ Choose the spreadsheet and Prospects tab in every Google Sheets node.
- ☒ Set the real Telegram chat ID across all four relevant Telegram nodes so approvals work.
- ☒ Prepare the Prospects sheet with the required columns and tracking fields.
- ☒ Test with one prospect row end-to-end before activating the workflow.

8 Node-by-Node Map

Cold Email	New prospect row → Validate prospect → Groq personalized outreach → Check outreach draft → Save outreach copy → Send or save Gmail draft → Record sent/unsent
Reply Detection	Check inbox (2 min) → Select active prospects → Search prospect replies → Choose unseen reply → Groq classify & respond → Record prospect reply → Notify about reply
Reply Drafting	Draft response appropriate? → Create response draft → Save response draft ID → Telegram reply draft ready
Telegram Approval	Approval button tapped → Read approval rows → Authorize draft send → Send approved Gmail draft → Record sent → Confirm in Telegram

SUMMARY

Designed and built end-to-end in n8n, demonstrating grounded AI copywriting, automated reply detection and classification, and a mobile-first human-approval gate for outbound communication.